

CDN Incident Alert: 0079. TLP: CLEAR**Date**

Title PL Unknown actor sponsors an advertising campaign of anonymous accounts on the Meta platform directed against presidential candidates in the 2025 Polish presidential election.

08/08/2025

Summary

- Two anonymous accounts on Facebook: "[Wiesz Jak Nie Jest](#)" and "[Stół Dorosłych](#)" were purchasing political advertisements on Facebook related to the presidential campaign. Journalists started reporting on this on April 25, suggesting external financing from outside Poland's borders, which is illegal according to Polish law.
- The pages discredit candidates Karol Nawrocki and Sławomir Mentzen while building a positive image of Rafał Trzaskowski based on leveraging existing narratives.
- The information campaign has influenced the polarization of society. Domestic actors ([Dariusz Matecki](#), [TV Republika](#)) have suggested an external operation, based on information about anonymous financing of the advertising campaign.
- The operation sought to degrade adversaries and cultivate support for a candidate through micro-targeted Meta ads, hiding their affiliations.
- The NASK Disinformation Analysis Center issued a warning on May 14 about a possible attempt to interfere in the election campaign, indicating that these advertising campaigns might be financed from abroad. The Internal Security Agency was informed about the matter. The NASK statement triggered a series of reactions in the Polish information space.
- Recommendations include making public information about the source of financing for the advertising campaign and transparent strategic communication from government institutions.

Incident

Between April 10 and May 15, 2025, two anonymous accounts on Facebook: "[Wiesz Jak Nie Jest](#)," and "[Stół Dorosłych](#)," registered on March 28 and 31, 2025 respectively, conducted an intensive political advertising campaign related to the presidential elections in Poland. These accounts published materials that discredited candidates Karol Nawrocki and Sławomir Mentzen, while simultaneously building a positive image of Rafał Trzaskowski. Approximately 460,339 PLN [as of 15/05] was spent on promoting these advertisements. [A spokesperson for Facebook's parent company Meta rejected the assertions of potential foreign meddling](#). In their opinion, the administrator accounts of the pages were registered in Poland. The source of campaign financing remains unknown. Regardless of its actual intent or impact on voter decisions, the campaign's form should be recognized as a potential vector of systemic risk, undermining electoral legitimacy, transparency, and the democratic order of the state.

Narrative

Meta-narratives: Right-wing politicians endanger women and society; Alternative candidates have criminal connections; Only experienced, responsible politicians can effectively govern the country.

Sub-narratives: Karol Nawrocki has connections to the criminal world; Sławomir Mentzen weakens women's position in Poland; Rafał Trzaskowski is the best candidate for president; Right-wing candidates threaten Polish democracy; Trzaskowski represents modern, European values unlike his opponents.

Impact

Reach: The "Wiesz jak nie jest" account conducted 104 advertisements with a total spend of 321,484 PLN, generating 16.646-19.042 million impressions and an average CPM of 16.89-19.31 PLN. The campaign primarily targeted users aged 30+ with the largest budget allocation going to the 30-39 age group (233,076 PLN). Gender targeting included 48 ads for women (88,408 PLN), 36 ads for men (56,903 PLN), and 20 ads for all genders (176,173 PLN). The demographic breakdown shows strategic focus on middle-aged audiences, with women receiving more targeted advertisements despite a lower per-capita budget allocation.

The "Stół Dorosłych" account conducted 32 advertisements with a total spend of 165,958 PLN, generating 11.095-12.845 million impressions and an average CPM of 12.92-14.95 PLN. The campaign primarily targeted users aged 30+ with the largest budget allocation going to the 30-39 age group (114,843 PLN). Gender targeting included 8 ads for women (51,095 PLN), 4 ads for men (22,726 PLN), and 20 ads for all genders (91,941 PLN). The demographic breakdown shows women receiving twice as many targeted advertisements as men despite a lower overall number of ads compared to the all-gender

category.

Outcome: The disinformation campaign conducted by anonymous Facebook accounts has contributed to the polarization of Polish society during the pre-election period, generating 245 articles between April 15 and May 15, and over 6000 posts on X. These activities, financed outside the official electoral committees, have deepened existing political divisions between voters of different candidates. The publication of information about possible foreign interference in the election campaign by NASK and media reports about connections with Akcja Demokracja and Estratos company have led to erosion of trust in the democratic process. It may lead to a long-term weakening of public trust in democratic systems and increase the vulnerability of public opinion to future disinformation campaigns. Attacks discrediting candidates may fuel aggressive political language and lower the standards of public debate.

The State Research Institute NASK issued a statement about possible external interference and referred the matter to special services (ABW) on May 14, 2025. The statement was issued in an imprecise manner - all candidates were treated equally as victims, which intensified public debate. The case generated high interest from media and candidates and their campaign teams, destabilizing the information space 5 days before the elections. The statement also contained incorrect information regarding Meta's response, to which the platform itself reacted. The statement suggested that Meta took action at NASK's request, while Meta denied this. No evidence was provided to back up the communication about possible external interference in the electoral process, and the opinion that the campaign may be a provocation aimed at the image of candidate Rafał Trzaskowski caused a storm among supporters of the than candidate Karol Nawrocki. The Law and Justice party, questioned the competency and impartiality of NASK.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

- Objective: [T0066 "Degrade Adversary"](#) – The operation attempts to weaken the image of Karol Nawrocki and Sławomir Mentzen by exploiting harmful information about their actions and reputation.
- Objective: [T0136.004 "Cultivate Support: Boost Reputation"](#) – The operation enhances respect for Rafał Trzaskowski in promoted content, improving his image and position..
- [T0114.001 "Deliver Ads: Social Media"](#) – The financed advertising campaign was conducted on the Meta platform.
- [T0072.001: Geographic Segmentation](#) – The operation is targeting specific areas by using postal codes.
- [T0130.001: Conceal Sponsorship](#) – The operation hides who is funding it, using a fabricated organisation name.
- [T0149.001: Domain Asset](#) – To get verified as an advertiser on Meta, the operation purchases a domain name that matched the name of the Facebook page they had created for the operation.

Recommendations and Actions Taken

- Action taken:** Continuation of monitoring the information space in Poland.
- Recommendations:** Disclosure of persons/institutions that transferred money for sponsored posts; Transparent strategic communication from NASK, ABW;

Report	Threat Actor	Evidence	Authors	Platforms	Logo
Upon Request	N/A	In text	Miłosz Dzienio, volunteer, INFO OPS Polska	Facebook, Instagram, Website.	X, 